AI Policy & Safety

2026-02-14 · 2 source items

2026-02-14 AI Policy & Safety Daily Brief

> Total: 2 articles Sources: Marcus on AI: 1 | Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow: 1

TLDR

other

Synthesis

Daily Executive Summary

OpenAI's IP Hypocrisy and Antitrust Inaction Highlight Systemic Tech Governance Gaps

Two developments on February 13, 2026 underscore deepening contradictions in tech policy and enforcement. First, AI researcher Gary Marcus highlights the irony of OpenAI—long criticized for training its models on copyrighted works without consent—now complaining about intellectual property (IP) violations against itself. This reversal exposes a double standard in how tech firms approach IP: aggressively leveraging others' creative output while demanding protection for their own. Meanwhile, a report from Pluralistic.net declares 'Trump antitrust is dead,' signaling the collapse of right-wing populist efforts to rein in Big Tech through antitrust mechanisms. The failure of this political movement suggests that neither major U.S. political faction has effectively addressed the structural power of dominant tech platforms. Together, these snippets reveal a regulatory vacuum where corporations simultaneously exploit and demand protection under IP law, while antitrust enforcement remains politically fragmented and ineffective. The juxtaposition of OpenAI's stance with the demise of a key antitrust initiative illustrates how legal and ethical frameworks have failed to keep pace with technological concentration. Without coherent policy, companies like OpenAI can continue extracting value from public creative commons while shielding their own assets—a dynamic that undermines both innovation and fairness. These developments should prompt renewed scrutiny of IP regimes in the age of generative AI and a reevaluation of cross-partisan antitrust strategies.

Key Takeaways

- OpenAI is now complaining about IP theft despite historically using others' copyrighted content without permission.
- Gary Marcus frames OpenAI's IP complaint as ironic and karmic given its past practices.
- The 'populist right's' antitrust agenda under Trump has effectively collapsed as of February 2026.
- Pluralistic.net reports that Trump-aligned antitrust efforts are no longer viable.
- Both major U.S. political factions lack effective strategies to regulate Big Tech's market power.
- Current IP laws enable tech firms to benefit from others' work while protecting their own outputs.
- The absence of consistent antitrust enforcement allows systemic imbalances in the tech sector to persist.

Evidence refs: C1-E1, C1-E2

Sentiment: negative | Reliability: med

---

1. other

AI Ethics - Intellectual Property

OpenAI Accused of Hypocrisy Over IP Theft Claims

Gary Marcus criticizes OpenAI for previously using artists' and writers' work without consent, now complaining about its own IP being copied—highlighting perceived hypocrisy and karmic irony.

Key Takeaways

- OpenAI faces backlash for allegedly exploiting creators' IP while seeking legal protections for its own
- Commentary underscores growing tension between AI firms and content creators over ownership and fair use

Sentiment: negative | Reliability: med

US Politics - Antitrust Policy

Trump-Era Antitrust Efforts Declared Dead

Pluralistic.net reports the collapse of Trump-aligned antitrust initiatives, framing the populist right's regulatory agenda as fundamentally unworkable and politically defunct as of February 2026.

Key Takeaways

- Trump-backed antitrust movement has failed to gain lasting institutional traction
- Analysis suggests inherent contradictions doomed the populist right’s competition policy agenda

Sentiment: neutral | Reliability: med

(Related articles: 2)

Sources

- Irony, Irony laced with Karma, and Terror [Marcus on AI] (2026-02-13) [published_at]
- Pluralistic: Trump antitrust is dead (13 Feb 2026) [Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow] (2026-02-13) [published_at]